

Braulio Britos

Personal Data

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Contact Information

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Citizenship: Uruguay, US (Green card holder)

Major Fields of Concentration

Macro Development, Misallocation, Migration, and Climate Change

Education

<i>Degree</i>	<i>Field</i>	<i>Institution</i>	<i>Year</i>
PhD	Economics	University of Minnesota	2024
MA	Economics	Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2018
BA	Economics	Universidad ORT Uruguay	2015

Publications

Britos, Braulio, Manuel A. Hernandez, Miguel Robles and Danilo Trupkin, “Land Market Distortions and Aggregate Agricultural Productivity: Evidence from Guatemala,” *Journal of Development Economics*, 2022.

Working Papers

Barbosa-Alves, Mauricio and Braulio Britos, “Climate Change and International Migration”

Barbosa-Alves, Mauricio and Braulio Britos, “Climate Change, Food Prices, and Inequality”

Britos, Braulio, Manuel A. Hernandez, and Danilo Trupkin, “Agricultural Distortions and International Migration”

Work in Progress

“Remittances, Human Capital, and Growth”

References

Professor Timothy Kehoe	(612) 625-1589 tkehoe@umn.edu	Department of Economics University of Minnesota 4-101 Hanson Hall
Professor Manuel Amador	(612) 624-4060 amador@umn.edu	1925 South Fourth Street Minneapolis, Minnesota 55455
Dr. Michael Waugh	michael.e.waugh@gmail.com	Research Department Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis 90 Hennepin Avenue
Dr. Simran Sahi	ssahi2007@gmail.com	Minneapolis, Minnesota, 55401

Working Experience

2025-Present	<i>Economist</i> , RESSI, International Monetary Fund (IMF), Washington, DC
2024-2025	<i>Senior Associate</i> , PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC), Boston, Massachusetts
2021-2023	<i>Instructor</i> , University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2019-2021	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2014-2017	<i>Research Assistant</i> , International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI), Washington, DC
2013-2014	<i>Research Assistant</i> , Universidad ORT Uruguay, Montevideo, Uruguay

Seminars and Conferences

2025	RESSI Seminars (IMF), 19th NAUEA (Montreal), LACEA 2025 (Recife)
2024	Tulane University (New Orleans), 3rd National Migration and Climate Change Forum (Guatemala)
2023	MN-WI International-Macro Student Workshop (Madison)

Honors and Awards

2013-2014	<i>Henry R. Sandor Fellowship in Environmental Economics</i> , University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2022-2023	<i>Distinguished Instructor</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2021	<i>Graduate Research Program Partnership Fellowship</i> , University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2018-2019	<i>Winkelmann and Gleason Fellowship</i> , University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2014-2015	<i>Introduction to Research Scholarship</i> , Agencia Nacional de Investigación e Innovación Productividad, Rendimiento y Tamaño: evidencia de establecimientos hortícolas en Canelones, Montevideo, Uruguay
2010-2015	<i>Academic Excellence Scholarship</i> , Universidad ORT, Uruguay, Montevideo, Uruguay

Teaching Experience

2022-2023	<i>Instructor</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Taught <i>International Trade</i> .
Spring 2022	<i>Instructor</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Taught <i>International Finance</i> .
Fall 2021	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Led a lecture for <i>Principles of Microeconomics</i> .
Summer 2021	<i>Instructor</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Taught <i>International Trade</i> .
Spring 2021	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Led a lecture for <i>Principles of Macroeconomics</i> .
Fall 2019	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Led three recitation sections for <i>Principles of Macroeconomics</i> .

Computer Skills

Stata, R, Julia, Matlab, ArcGIS, CSPro, SurveyToGo, and LaTeX

Languages

Spanish (native) and English (fluent)

Abstract(s)

Alves, Mauricio and Braulio Britos, “Climate Change and International Migration,”

This paper studies the impact of climate change on international migration. Using census data from Guatemala, we document novel evidence suggesting that areas affected by a high-heat shock exhibit less migration in the next period. The magnitude is larger in rural areas, where high-heat shocks decrease rural productivity. We postulate that in the short run, high-heat shocks stop migration from credit-constrained agents needing to pay the migration cost. In this context, climate change’s effects are two-sided. While declining rural productivity makes migration more appealing, it also makes it increasingly difficult to pay the migration cost. We develop this idea by building a dynamic incomplete-markets migration model with migration costs where high-heat shocks affect rural productivity in credit-constrained households. We then estimate the model to match the high-heat migration link. We show that migration flows increase for different climate change scenarios. Additionally, we find that transfers providing insurance against high-heat shocks decrease migration under all climate change scenarios. Counterintuitively, although the high-heat transfer alleviates the cost of migration, its insurance effect makes staying more appealing.

Britos, Braulio, Manuel A. Hernandez, Miguel Robles and Danilo Trupkin, “Land Market Distortions and Aggregate Agricultural Productivity: Evidence from Guatemala,” *Journal of Development Economics*, 2022

Farm size and land allocation are important factors in explaining lagging agricultural productivity in developing countries. This paper examines the effect of land market imperfections on land allocation across farmers and aggregate agricultural productivity. We develop a theoretical framework to model the optimal size distribution of farms and assess to what extent market imperfections can explain non-optimal land allocation and output inefficiency. We measure these distortions for the case of Guatemala using agricultural census microdata. We find that due to land market imperfections aggregate output is 19% below its efficient level for both maize and beans and 31% below for coffee, which are three major crops produced nationwide. We also observe that areas with higher distortions show higher land price dispersion and less active rental markets. The degree of land market distortions across areas co-vary to some extent with road accessibility, ethnicity, and education.

Alves, Mauricio and Braulio Britos, “Climate Change, Food Prices, and Inequality”

This paper examines how climate change will affect food prices across regions and people across the income distribution, emphasizing the uneven effects on agricultural productivity. As climate change shifts comparative advantages in food production, trade frictions limit adaptive sourcing. These frictions induce local sourcing, making food prices dependent on local productivity and increasing prices everywhere. Low-income households, with higher food expenditure shares, are particularly vulnerable to local food price increases. We develop a spatial macro trade model that incorporates income heterogeneity and two types of food goods with different trade frictions, allowing us to decompose welfare losses stemming from climate change into food expenditure shares, trade shares, and productivity changes. Using Brazilian data, we estimate intra-national trade shares using short-term weather shocks, price changes, and driving times between states. We find that trade frictions for fresh food are twice as sensitive to driving time relative to commodities, which face lower trade costs. Counterfactuals based on productivity forecasts indicate substantial welfare losses, with the lowest income decile in the most affected states willing to forgo 3% of income to avoid projected productivity declines. Improving road infrastructure could mitigate these effects, with low-income households in some states willing to pay up to 0.8% of their income for a 10% increase in the average driving speed.

Abstract(s) (cont)

Britos, Braulio, Manuel A. Hernandez, and Danilo Trupkin, “Agricultural Distortions and International Migration”

International migration is a recurrent phenomenon that has grown rapidly over the past two decades. This paper examines the role of agricultural distortions in shaping emigration patterns and influencing productivity and welfare in developing countries, using Guatemala as a case study. We develop a theoretical framework where household members can work in agriculture, non-agriculture, or emigrate, and calibrate the model combining detailed micro and aggregate data. Our model identifies two key channels through which agricultural distortions affect migration and productivity: a first channel where distortions increase emigration among more productive agents, reducing aggregate productivity, and a second channel where distortions drive factor misallocation, lowering incomes and increasing overall emigration. Quantitatively, reducing agricultural distortions to the most efficient department in each region would lower the share of emigrants by 2.3 percentage points, primarily among more productive workers. Lower distortions would similarly boost aggregate agricultural productivity by 30.1% and raise median household welfare by 4.5%. An analysis at the sub-national level reveals that high-distortion areas are more isolated and exhibit less financial penetration and government presence.